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Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM



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A citizen, now alone

Eva Gurtovaia pauses while talking about her husband, Enes Abak, at their home in Chicago's Uptown neighborhood. Gurtovaia, a former Russian citizen of Belarusian and Ukrainian descent, attended her U.S. citizenship ceremony on Wednesday, the day after Abak, a Turkish citizen of Kurdish descent, was taken by immigration agents while leaving for work. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Clips reveal depths of Halloween violence



Footage from Evanston police depicts a tense scene on Oct. 31. **CITY OF EVANSTON**

By Richard Requena and Jonathan Bullington
Pioneer Press

The Evanston police officers stepped out of their squad cars and into a pressure cooker.

By the time they arrived at the normally subdued south Evanston intersection that Halloween afternoon, a car crash involving a red sedan and an SUV full of U.S. Customs and Border Protection agents had devolved into violence and chaos.

The sedan's driver and two other people — all U.S. citizens — already had been

detained. One of them, a young Chicago man, was captured on witness video being wrestled to the pavement and punched in the head while handcuffed.

With their body-worn cameras rolling, Evanston officers encountered armed federal agents surrounded by an angry crowd shouting for the three citizens to be released. Some chastised agents for being in their neighborhood. Some pleaded with cops to do something about the agent seen hitting the young Chicago man and a second agent, also caught on cellphone footage,

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Agents' barrage detailed on film

Judge says bodycam videos released to public undercut feds' use-of-force reports

By Jason Meisner, Madeline Buckley, Jonathan Bullington and Adriana Pérez
Chicago Tribune

Footage from nearly four dozen body cameras worn by immigration agents during Operation Midway Blitz was released to the public on Wednesday, capturing in shaky, first-person style the abject chaos on the streets as residents and protesters were tear-gassed, hit with pepper balls and arrested during protests of immigration enforcement actions.

The group of videos made public through the Loevy & Loevy law firm includes footage from agents who responded to controversial arrest operations in the Little Village and Irving Park neighborhoods.

The videos show agents lobbing flash grenades at protesters outside the Broadview immigration detention center and interrogating Chicago residents on city sidewalks.

In one clip, Border Patrol Cmdr. Gregory Bovino tells agents to force an angry crowd back from a perimeter fence outside the Broadview immigration detention center and arrest anyone who doesn't comply.

Another depicts agents in a lengthy high-speed vehicle pursuit through Chicago's East Side neighborhood that ended in a crash and one agent chasing the vehicle's suspected passenger into a nearby Walgreens.

U.S. District Judge Sara Ellis ordered the 43 videos released after she relied heavily on them in issuing a preliminary

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Soybean farmers struggle with trade war, rising costs

By Jerry Wu
Chicago Tribune

On his family's more than century-old farm in Greenville, Scott Gaffner brought in his soybeans this fall much like any other year. But, like thousands of other farmers across Illinois and the country, he began harvesting crops in September without a single order from China, the world's largest buyer.

Soybeans are Illinois' largest agricultural export, and last year, the state exported more than \$1.4 billion worth of soybeans to China, according to the Illinois Department of Agriculture. This year, an unpredictable trade war with China, rising costs and competition from South America are hitting farmers hard, especially in Illinois, the largest soybean producer in the country.

"In the long term, we lose market access, we lose the ability to have decent prices," Gaffner said. "It affects us in the long run,

and that could mean some of our businesses and operations may go out of business."

After returning to office, President Donald Trump escalated a trade war begun in 2018 during his first term. Beijing imposed a series of retaliatory tariffs on American goods, making U.S. soybeans far less competitive and shuttering a critical market for American farmers.

In late October, the Trump administration announced it had secured an agreement with China to purchase 12 million metric tons of U.S. soybeans before the end of the year. Many experts — including a recent U.S. Department of Agriculture report — have already cast doubt on the deal's promises, even as farmers remain hopeful that their largest buyer will return. In 2024, China bought 26.8 million metric tons of soybeans.

The uncertainty surrounding the trade

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DOMINIC DI PALERMO/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Hear those sleigh bells jingle

Santa Claus and Mrs. Claus wave to the crowd during the 91st annual Chicago Thanksgiving Parade on Friday. Santa's arrival rings in the holiday season, and he might have brought some North Pole weather with him. Heavy snowfall with possible accumulations over 6 inches could affect holiday travel across the region on Saturday. **Chicagoland, Page 6**

Afghan national allegedly drove across US to carry out attack

By Ben Finley, Alanna Durkin Richer and Anthony Izaguirre
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump said that one of the two West Virginia National Guard members shot by an Afghan national near the White House had died,

calling the shooter who had worked with the CIA in his native country a "savage monster."

As part of his Thanksgiving call to U.S. troops, Trump said that he had just learned that Specialist Sarah Beckstrom, 20, had died, while Staff Sgt. Andrew Wolfe, 24, was "fighting for his life."

Trump used the announcement to say the

shooting was a "terrorist attack" as he criticized the Biden administration for enabling Afghans who worked with U.S. forces during the war in Afghanistan to enter the U.S. The president has deployed National Guard members in part to assist in his administration's mass deportation efforts.

Trump suggested that the shooter was

mentally unstable after the war and departure from Afghanistan.

"He went cuckoo. I mean, he went nuts," the president said. "It happens too often with these people."

The suspect charged with the shooting is

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